

Jesu, joy of our desiring

Text: Martin Janus, 1665, trans. Robert Bridges, 1927

Music: Johann Schopp, 1642, harm. J. S. Bach, 1716

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The musical score is written for a single voice part on a treble clef staff. The key signature has one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 3/4. The melody is simple and hymn-like, with a mix of quarter, eighth, and half notes, and rests. The lyrics are written below the staff, with some lines numbered 1 and 2 to indicate different verses. The music ends with a double bar line.

1 Je - su, joy of our de - sir - ing, ho - ly wis - dom, love most bright,
2 Through the way, where hope is guid-ing, hark, what peace - ful mu - sic rings,
drawn by thee, our souls as - pir-ing soar to un - cre - at - ed light.
where the flock, in thee con - fid-ing, drink of joy from death-less springs.
Word of God, our flesh that fash-ioned, with the fire of life im - pas-sioned,
Theirs is beau-ty's fair - est pleas-ure. Theirs is wis-dom's ho - liest treas - ure.
striv - ing still to truth un - known, soar - ing, dy - ing round thy throne.
Thou dost ev - er lead thine own in the love of joys un - known.